



*BVR Mohan Reddy on the occasion of Geospatial World Leadership Awards*

“We used to have a weekly off on Monday because of the power considerations in Hyderabad. So, on Sunday afternoons, I used to draft and send a bill of materials listing all the components I would need to produce 450 diesel engines by the coming week. In those days, everything was handwritten as there wasn’t any Excel,” he elaborates

Be it cylinders or piston rings—six piston rings per engine—by four o’clock every Sunday evening, Mohan would gather all his documentation listing all the parts that were not available and travel to the railway station to catch a 7:30 PM train from Hyderabad to Kolhapur, Maharashtra, which is where most of the suppliers were based. “I did not have a reservation, so I carried a sheaf of newspapers in my hand; not for reading, but to spread in the third class compartment in front of the toilet, to sleep,” he narrates.

Collecting the parts the next morning, Mohan travelled back to Hyderabad on Monday night, ready with all the components for pro-

duction on Tuesday morning. “The production at the assembly line could not ever stop for any reason!” he exclaims.

The company never paid any extra money to this young trainee for all this extra hustle-bustle, but Lala Shri Ram noticed the young man’s efforts and acknowledged him as a star performer. The young entrepreneur in Mohan Reddy was slowly coming into his own. “My job was completed on time, and the assembly line never came to a standstill—this gave me immense satisfaction. The task never mattered; it was my task, and that was what was important. I developed an entrepreneurial mindset by taking ownership of every task assigned to me and making up my mind to better my best performance every time,” he proudly states.

After completing three years in industry learning all about industry operations, human resources management, and production planning, Mohan pursued a second post-graduate degree in Industrial Operations

and Management from the University of Michigan. While the dream of becoming an entrepreneur was still alive, Mohan’s education played a pertinent role in solidifying his plans and igniting the fire. “During my time there, I did a small course in business management taught by Prof. LaRue Hosmer at the Ross School of Entrepreneurship, who taught this course via case studies. I learnt a lot about how to run a small business and gained a lot of confidence in my abilities with my teacher’s encouragement. To date, I believe that taking up that course was a significant turning point in my life, that made me believe in my dream of setting up my own business and being an entrepreneur,” he elucidates.

The University of Michigan set the genesis for Mohan’s plans, and he figured that computers were going to be the future. “I returned to India in 1977 and started looking for a computer-related job. In those days, it was called electronic data processing (EDP). I, a mechanical and industrial engineer, was all into